



Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City



Fantasy CTF

FANTASY CTF 



Easy

General Skills

picoCTF 2025

browser_webshell_solvable

AUTHOR: SYREAL

Description

Play this short game to get familiar with terminal applications and some of the most important rules in scope for picoCTF. Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: **NOT_RUNNING**

Launch Instance

Hints

1

When a choice is presented like [a/b/c], choose one, for example: **c** and then press Enter.

41,462 users solved



74% Liked



 picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit Flag

Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: FANTASY CTF

Category: General Skills

Date: 03/03/26



I. Objective

The objective of this challenge is to interact with a **text-based program running on a remote server** and follow the correct sequence of choices to reach the end of the game, where the flag is revealed. This challenge focuses on understanding **network connections, terminal interaction, and following program logic**.

II. Background

In Capture The Flag (CTF) challenges, not all problems involve hacking or exploiting vulnerabilities. Some challenges are designed to test **basic technical skills**, such as:

- Connecting to remote services
- Reading instructions carefully
- Understanding menu-driven programs
- Navigating command-line interfaces

This challenge simulates a **fantasy-style game** that runs entirely in the terminal. The key lesson is that sometimes the solution is not about breaking security, but about **correct interaction and attention to detail**.

III. Tool Used

- **Oracle VirtualBox (Kali Linux)** – Used as the Linux environment
- **Linux Terminal** – Used to execute decoding commands

IV. Methodology

1. Launched the challenge instance to generate the remote server and connection details.



Its current status is: **NOT_RUNNING**

Launch Instance

2. Opened Oracle VirtualBox and booted into Kali Linux.
3. Opened the Linux terminal (Bash).
4. Connected to the remote service using the nc (netcat) command provided by the challenge.

```
File Actions Edit View Help
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ nc verbal-sleep.picoc.tf.net 58431
```

5. Read the introductory text displayed by the fantasy game simulation.

```
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ nc verbal-sleep.picoc.tf.net 58431
FANTASY CTF SIMULATION

The simulation begins in the private room of Eibhilin, a bright, young student.
The room is dimly lit, with the glow of her multiple monitors casting an
electric blue hue on the walls. Around the room are posters of vintage movies
from the MCU – ancient guardians from another age staring down like digital
sentinels.

—
(Press Enter to continue... )
```

6. Pressed **Enter** multiple times to continue through the story prompts.



FANTASY CTF SIMULATION

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—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

Eibhilin stretches back in her chair, adjusting the holo-display of her keyboard. A soft hum of a nearby server fills the air as her AI companion, 'Nyx', comes to life.

—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

"Good evening, Ei," Nyx chirps, "The 3025 edition of picoCTF registration is open. You asked me to remind so you could try out the competition for the first time. Do you wish to proceed?"

—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

Outside, the city of Nexalus glimmers under the stars, but Eibhilin's focus remains entirely on the screen in front of her.

—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

"Yes, Nyx. Let's do it!"

—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

7. Selected "C" to create a single and private account.

"Yes, Nyx. Let's do it!"

—
(Press Enter to continue...)
—

Nyx brings up the registration page.

Options:

- A) *Register multiple accounts*
 - B) *Share an account with a friend*
 - C) *Register a single, private account*
- [a/b/c] > c

Nyx nods, "Good choice, Ei. Let's proceed with a single, private account. It can be tempting to try and do something 'clever', but registering multiple accounts or sharing an account with a friend can lead to disqualification."



8. Continued pressing **Enter** to progress through the setup.

```
File Actions Edit View Help
can be tempting to try and do something 'clever', but registering multiple
accounts or sharing an account with a friend can lead to disqualification."

(Press Enter to continue ...)

"Ok," Nyx says, "Registering you for the competition... There's an introductory
audio message, piping to your speakers."

(Press Enter to continue ...)

"Welcome hacker! You're about to embark on a journey that will teach you many
esoteric and valuable skills. Our mission is to guide you in the right path,
that you may use these skills to protect and defend and never for selfish gain
or deceit. We hope you enjoy the challenges that our authors have devised this
year. Always remember: 'With great power, comes great responsibility!'"

(Press Enter to continue ...)

Nyx continues, "I've gleaned from the Ether that in CTF competitions, it's
always good to start with the 'sanity' challenge. It should be the challenge
worth the least amount of points. I'll pull it up. You're looking for something
called the flag. You should know it when you see it."

(Press Enter to continue ...)

"Oh interesting," Eibhilin says, "It seems like the sanity challenge is an old
school interactive fiction game."

(Press Enter to continue ...)
```

9. Selected “A” to play the game.

```
Options:
A) *Play the game*
B) *Search the Ether for the flag*
[a/b] > a

"Good choice, Ei," Nyx says, "You never want to share flags or artifact
downloads."

(Press Enter to continue ...)

Playing the Game
Playing the Game: 100% [time left: 00:00]
Playing the Game completed successfully!
```




VI. Explanation

Think of this challenge like a **choose-your-own-adventure book**, but instead of reading it on paper, you interact with it through a computer terminal.

What is nc (netcat)?

Netcat is like a **phone call tool for computers**:

- You dial a server address and port
- The server “talks back”
- You type responses and press Enter

Here, the server is hosting a **game program**, not a website.

Why no hacking was needed?

This challenge was not about exploiting bugs or bypassing security. Instead, it tested whether you could:

- Follow instructions
- Understand menu options
- Choose the correct inputs
- Be patient and methodical

The flag was revealed simply by **reaching the end of the program flow**.

What this challenge teaches:

- Not every CTF problem is an attack
- Reading carefully is a technical skill
- Command-line interaction is fundamental in cybersecurity
- Many real systems still run entirely in text mode



VII. Conclusion

Fantasy CTF emphasizes the importance of **basic technical literacy** in cybersecurity. Understanding how to interact with remote services, navigate terminal programs, and follow structured workflows is essential before moving on to more advanced exploitation techniques.

This challenge reinforces that sometimes the simplest approach—reading, understanding, and responding correctly—is the most effective solution.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**